Organisation and the Congress of Democrats), had already developed a hostile view of "tribalism" or ethnicity in its Freedom Charter of 1955, which stressed the unity of South Africa and which opposed the politics of ethnicity. Intellectually, these positions were underpinned by a critique of the dangers of ethnic mobilization as evident in the Afrikaner national movement. These ideas were further reinforced from the 1960s by Marxian currents within the academy, both in South Africa and abroad. Scholars deconstructed ethnicity while demonstrating how it was being manipulated and used in South Africa as a means to divide and rule, evident in the apartheid project with its proposed puppet ethnic "homelands."[28]

A broadly "Third Worldist" and anti-colonial *Weltanschauung* evolved among exiled and domestic activists. They took a decidedly dyspeptic view of the West, its support for the apartheid state and the Pretoria-Jerusalem axis that began to evolve from the early 1970s. With such views came a growing identification with third world liberation movements and the PLO. By the late 1980s an increasingly radicalized left already attacked Israel as an exclusivist apartheid state. At the United Nations, Dr. Neo Mnumzama, the Chief Representative of ANC—still in exile at the time—put it bluntly: "The South African people have never approved of Zionism," he explained. "They see parallels of apartheid in Zionism and therefore their struggle against apartheid automatically has overtones of anti-Zionism which is not the same thing as being anti-Jewish."[29] These views were shared by Aubrey Mokoena, a senior member of the United Democratic Front which was effectively an internal wing of the ANC. Zionism, he maintained, was simply racism, "because Zionism says we close our ranks on an ethnic basis. We take care of the Jewish interests. If you are Jewish it's okay, if you are not Jewish, *out*."[30]A former president of the (Africanist) Azanian Political Organization (Azapo), Ishmael Mkhabela, took a similar view, claiming that Zionism was a form of religious discrimination which was, in his view, the same as the racial discrimination faced by blacks in South Africa.[31]

This alleged exclusivity ran counter to the non-racial and inclusivist outlook of the ANC liberation movement, both in exile and at home. With it went a sense of unease with a Jewish state and an easy sympathy for the PLO.[32] There is no doubt, said the prominent civic leader, Dr Nthato Motlana, "that Black Africans tend to identify with the PLO. . . . Let's be clear about this, there is a perception of the Israeli-Arab conflict as one of almost colonialism of a white race coming out of Europe."[33]

It is hardly surprising that with the release of Nelson Mandela in 1990, the unbanning of the ANC and other proscribed movements, and the normalization of South African politics, a broad hostility towards Zionism

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